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Anti-peeping display device

Abstract

A display device includes a substrate including a display area including a light emitting area, and a peripheral area surrounding at least a portion of the display area, a first light emitting element disposed in the light emitting area on the substrate and emitting a first light, a light guide layer disposed on the first light emitting element, and transmitting a second light incident from the peripheral area to the display area, a first low refractive layer disposed on the light guide layer and having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer, a second low refractive layer disposed under the light guide layer and having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer and a first light control layer disposed on the first low refractive layer and having a first opening exposing the light emitting area.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This application claims priority to and the benefit of Korean Patent Application No. 10-2021-0134936, filed on Oct. 12, 2021, which is hereby incorporated by reference for all purposes as if

fully set forth herein.

BACKGROUND

1. Field

(2) Embodiments relates generally to a display device. More particularly, embodiments relate to the display device that provides visual information.

2. Description of the Related Art

(3) A flat panel display device is being used as a display device that replaces a cathode ray tube display due to characteristics such as light weight and thinness. Representative examples of such flat panel display devices include a liquid crystal display device and an organic light emitting display device.

(4) In general, a display device is manufactured to implement a wide viewing angle. However, a display device with a narrow viewing angle may be required so that no one other than the user can see a screen in a public place.

SUMMARY

(5) Embodiment provides a display device in which a viewing angle may be adjusted.

(6) A display device according to an embodiment may include a substrate including a display area including a light emitting area and a light blocking area, and a peripheral area surrounding at least a portion of the display area, a first light emitting element disposed in the light emitting area on the substrate and emitting a first light, a light guide layer disposed on the first light emitting element to cover the display area and the peripheral area, and transmitting a second light incident from the peripheral area to the display area, a first low refractive layer disposed on the light guide layer and having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer, a second low refractive layer disposed under the light guide layer and having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer and a first light control layer disposed on the first low refractive layer and having a first opening exposing the light emitting area.

(7) According to an embodiment, the display device may further include a second light control layer disposed under the second low refractive layer and having a second opening exposing the light emitting area.

(8) According to an embodiment, each of the first light control layer and the second light control layer may include a photochromic material that is discolored by the second light.

(9) According to an embodiment, the first light control layer may directly contact the first low refractive layer. The second light control layer may directly contact the second low refractive layer.

(10) According to an embodiment, the first opening and the second opening may overlap with each other. The first light emitting element may overlap the first opening and the second opening, respectively.

(11) According to an embodiment, the display device may further include a third light control layer disposed on the first light control layer, having a third opening exposing the light emitting area, and including a photochromic material that is discolored by the second light.

(12) According to an embodiment, the display device may further include an insulating layer disposed between the first light control layer and the third light control layer, and covering the first light control layer.

(13) According to an embodiment, the display device may further include a plurality of scattering patterns disposed between the light guide layer and the first low refractive layer. Each of the scattering patterns may overlap the first light control layer.

(14) According to an embodiment, each of the scattering patterns may include an insulating film and a plurality of scattering particles dispersed in the insulating film.

(15) According to an embodiment, a width of each of the scattering patterns may be smaller than a width of the first light control layer.

(16) According to an embodiment, each of the first low refractive layer and the second low refractive layer may include a plurality of air bubbles disposed therein.

- (17) According to an embodiment, a refractive index of each of the first low refractive layer and the second low refractive layer may be smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer by about 0.2 or more.
- (18) According to an embodiment, the display device may further include a second light emitting element disposed in the peripheral area on the substrate and emitting the second light.
- (19) According to an embodiment, the display device may further include a second light emitting element disposed to face a side surface of the light guide layer and emitting the second light.
- (20) According to an embodiment, the first light may be visible light. The second light may be infrared or ultraviolet light.
- (21) A display device according to an embodiment may include a substrate including a display area including a light emitting area and a light blocking area, and a peripheral area surrounding at least a portion of the display area, a first light emitting element disposed in the light emitting area on the substrate and emitting a first light, a light guide layer disposed on the first light emitting element to cover the display area and the peripheral area, and transmitting a second light incident from the peripheral area to the display area, a light control layer disposed in the display area on the first light emitting element, having an opening exposing the light emitting area, and disposed to be spaced apart from the light guide layer and a low refractive layer disposed between the light guide layer and the light control layer, and having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer.
- (22) According to an embodiment, the low refractive layer may include a first low refractive layer disposed on the light guide layer and a second low refractive layer disposed under the light guide layer.
- (23) According to an embodiment, each of the first low refractive layer and the second low refractive layer may include a plurality of air bubbles disposed therein.
- (24) According to an embodiment, the light control layer may include a first light control layer disposed on the first low refractive layer and a second light control layer disposed under the second low refractive layer.
- (25) According to an embodiment, the display device may further include a plurality of scattering patterns disposed between the light guide layer and the first low refractive layer, each of the scattering patterns overlapping the first light control layer.
- (26) In a display device according to an embodiment of the present inventive concept, the display device may display an image in a first mode state implemented with a wide viewing angle or a second mode state implemented with a narrow viewing angle. A first low refractive layer having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer may be disposed under the light guide layer, and a second low refractive layer having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer may be disposed on the light guide layer. In addition, a first light control layer including a photochromic material that is discolored by light having a specific wavelength range may be disposed under the first low refractive layer, and a second light control layer including a photochromic material that is discolored by light having a specific wavelength range may be disposed on the second low refractive layer. Accordingly, when the display device is in the second mode state, the light of a specific wavelength range incident into the light guide layer in a peripheral area may be uniformly transmitted over an entire display area by total reflection.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) Illustrative, non-limiting embodiments will be more clearly understood from the following detailed description in conjunction with the accompanying drawings.
- (2) FIG. 1 is a plan view illustrating a display device according to an embodiment.

- (3) FIGS. 2A and 2B are cross-sectional views taken along line I-I' of FIG. 1.
- (4) FIGS. 3A and 3B are plan views illustrating an example of a light control layer of FIG. 2A.
- (5) FIGS. 4A and 4B are plan views illustrating another example of a light control layer of FIG. 2A.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a display device according to another embodiment.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a display device according to still another embodiment.
- (8) FIGS. 7A and 7B are a cross-sectional view illustrating a display device according to still another embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

- (9) Hereinafter, embodiments of the present disclosure will be explained in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. The same reference numerals are used for the same components in the drawings, and redundant descriptions of the same components will be omitted.
- (10) FIG. 1 is a plan view illustrating a display device according to an embodiment.
- (11) Referring to FIG. 1, the display device **10** according to an embodiment may include a display area DA and a peripheral area PA. A plurality of pixels may be disposed in the display area DA. An image may be displayed through the pixels in the display area DA. An image may not be displayed in the peripheral area PA. The peripheral area PA may be located outside the display area DA. For example, the peripheral area PA may surround the display area DA in a plan view.
- (12) The display area DA may include a plurality of light emitting areas LA and a light blocking area BA. Each of the pixels may be disposed in each of the light emitting areas LA. For example, the light emitting areas LA may be arranged in a matrix form along a first direction D1 and a second direction D2 intersecting the first direction D1. The first direction D1 may be perpendicular to the second direction D2. The light blocking area BA may surround the light emitting areas LA in a plan view.
- (13) A first light emitting element (e.g., the first light emitting element **310** of FIG. 2A) may be disposed in each of the light emitting areas LA. The first light emitting element may emit a first light having a first wavelength range. The first light may be visible light. For example, each of the light emitting areas LA may emit any one of red light, green light, and blue light. Specifically, the light emitting areas LA may include a first light emitting area from which the red light is emitted, a second light emitting area from which the green light is emitted, and a third light emitting area from which the blue light is emitted.
- (14) A light blocking layer may be disposed in the light blocking area BA. In an embodiment, the light blocking layer may be a black matrix. The light blocking layer may prevent the first lights (e.g., red light, green light, and blue light) emitted from the light emitting areas LA from being mixed with each other.
- (15) A second light emitting element (e.g., the second light emitting element **320** of FIG. 2A) may be disposed in the peripheral area PA. Alternatively, the second light emitting element may be disposed in the display area DA. The second light emitting element may emit a second light having a second wavelength range different from the first wavelength range. The second light may be ultraviolet or infrared light. For example, a viewing angle of the display device **10** may be adjusted by the second light. A detailed description thereof will be provided later. In an embodiment, the number of the second light emitting element may be plural.
- (16) However, although the display device **10** of the present inventive concept is limited to an organic light emitting display device ("OLED"), the configuration of the present inventive concept is not limited thereto. In other embodiments, the display device **10** may include a liquid crystal display device ("LCD"), a field emission display device ("FED"), a plasma display device ("PDP"), an electrophoretic display device ("EPD"), an inorganic light emitting display device ("ILED"), or a quantum dot display device. Hereinafter, an example in which the display device **10** of the present inventive concept includes the organic light emitting display device will be described.

(17) FIGS. 2A and 2B are cross-sectional views taken along line I-I' of FIG. 1. For example, FIG. 2A may illustrate the display device **10** in a first mode state and FIG. 2B may illustrate the display device **10** in a second mode state. Here, the first mode state may be a mode for implementing a wide viewing angle and the second mode state may be a mode for implementing a narrow viewing angle.

(18) Referring to FIGS. 1, 2A, and 2B, the display device **10** according to an embodiment may include a first substrate **100**, an insulating structure IL, a first driving element **210**, a first light emitting element **310**, a second driving element **220**, a second light emitting element **320**, a pixel defining layer PDL, an encapsulation layer ENC, a touch sensing layer TC, a light collection layer CTL, a light control layer **400**, a low refractive layer **500**, a light guide layer **600**, scattering patterns **700**, a light absorption layer **800**, and a second substrate **900**.

(19) As described above, the display device **10** may include the display area DA and the peripheral area PA. As the display device **10** includes the display area DA and the peripheral area PA, the first substrate **100** may also include the display area DA and the peripheral area PA.

(20) The first substrate **100** may include a transparent material or an opaque material. For example, the first substrate **100** may be a transparent insulating substrate. Examples of the material that can be used for the first substrate **100** may be glass, quartz, plastic, and the like.

(21) The first driving element **210** may be disposed in the display area DA on the first substrate **100**. In addition, the second driving element **220** may be disposed in the peripheral area PA on the first substrate **100**. In an embodiment, a semiconductor layer of each of the first driving element **210** and the second driving element **220** may include amorphous silicon, polycrystalline silicon, or a metal oxide semiconductor. Examples of materials that can be used for the metal oxide semiconductor may be indium (In), gallium (Ga), tin (Sn), zirconium (Zr), vanadium (V), hafnium ("Hf"), cadmium (Cd), germanium (Ge), chromium (Cr), titanium (Ti), zinc (Zn), or the like. These may be used alone or in combination with each other.

(22) The insulating structure IL may be disposed on the first driving element **210** and the second driving element **220**. The insulating structure IL may cover the first driving element **210** and the second driving element **220**. For example, the insulating structure IL may include an inorganic insulating layer, an organic insulating layer, or the like. These may be used alone or in combination with each other.

(23) A first lower electrode **311** may be disposed in the display area DA on the insulating structure IL. Specifically, the first lower electrode **311** may be disposed in the light emitting area LA on the insulating structure IL. In addition, the second lower electrode **321** may be disposed in the peripheral area PA on the insulating structure IL. The first lower electrode **311** may be electrically connected to the first driving element **210**. The second lower electrode **321** may be electrically connected to the second driving element **220**. For example, each of the first lower electrode **311** and the second lower electrode **321** may include a metal, an alloy, a conductive metal oxide, a conductive metal nitride, a transparent conductive material, or the like. These may be used alone or in combination with each other.

(24) The pixel defining layer PDL may be disposed on the insulating structure IL on the first lower electrode **311** and the second lower electrode **321**. The pixel defining layer PDL may have openings exposing at least a portion of each of the first lower electrode **311** and the second lower electrode **321**. For example, the first opening may expose a central portion of the first lower electrode **311**. The second opening may expose a central portion of the second lower electrode **321**. The pixel defining layer PDL may cover a peripheral portion of each of the first lower electrode **311** and the second lower electrode **321**. For example, the pixel defining layer PDL may include an organic insulating material.

(25) A first light emitting layer **312** may be disposed on the first lower electrode **311** exposed by the first opening. That is, the first light emitting layer **312** may be disposed in the first opening. The first light emitting layer **312** may include an organic light emitting material emitting the first light

L1 having the first wavelength range.

(26) A second light emitting layer **322** may be disposed on the second lower electrode **321** exposed by the second opening. That is, the second light emitting layer **322** may be disposed in the second opening. The second light emitting layer **322** may include an organic light emitting material emitting the second light L2 having the second wavelength range.

(27) A first upper electrode **313** may be disposed on the first light emitting layer **312** and a second upper electrode **323** may be disposed on the second light emitting layer **322**. In an embodiment, the first upper electrode **313** and the second upper electrode **323** may be integrally formed. In this case, the first upper electrode **313** and the second upper electrode **323** may be entirely disposed in the display area DA and the peripheral area PA. In another embodiment, the first upper electrode **313** and the second upper electrode **323** may be separated. For example, each of the first upper electrode **313** and the second upper electrode **323** may include a metal, an alloy, a conductive metal oxide, a conductive metal nitride, a transparent conductive material, or the like. These may be used alone or in combination with each other.

(28) Accordingly, the first light emitting element **310** including the first lower electrode **311**, the first light emitting layer **312**, and the first upper electrode **313** may be disposed in the display area DA on the first substrate **100**. The second light emitting element **320** including the second lower electrode **321**, the second light emitting layer **322**, and the second upper electrode **323** may be disposed in the peripheral area PA of the first substrate **100**.

(29) The first light emitting element **310** may emit the first light L1 having the first wavelength range. The first light L1 may be visible light. For example, the first light L1 may be any one of red light, green light, and blue light.

(30) The second light emitting element **320** may be formed using some of dummy pixels formed in the peripheral area PA during a manufacturing process of the display device **10**. The second light emitting element **320** may emit the second light L2 having the second wavelength range. For example, the second light L2 may include various types of light (e.g., ultraviolet light, infrared light, visible light, and the like) having a different wavelength range from the first wavelength range. Hereinafter, a case in which the second light L2 is ultraviolet light will be described as an example.

(31) The first light emitting element **310** may be driven by the first driving element **210** and the second light emitting element **320** may be driven by the second driving element **220**. That is, the second light emitting element **320** emitting the second light L2 may be driven independently of the first light emitting element **310** emitting the first light L1. For example, the second driving element **220** may not drive the second light emitting element **320** when the display device **10** is in the first mode state. The second driving element **220** may drive the second light emitting element **320** when the display device **10** is in the second mode state.

(32) The encapsulation layer ENC may be disposed on the first upper electrode **313** and the second upper electrode **323**. Specifically, the encapsulation layer ENC may be entirely cover the display area DA and the peripheral area PA. The encapsulation layer ENC may cover the first light emitting element **310** and the second light emitting element **320**, and may protect the first light emitting element **310** and the second light emitting element **320** from external impurities.

(33) The encapsulation layer ENC may include at least one inorganic encapsulation layer and at least one organic encapsulation layer. For example, the encapsulation layer ENC may include a first inorganic encapsulation layer, an organic encapsulation layer disposed on the first inorganic encapsulation layer, and a second inorganic encapsulation layer disposed on the organic encapsulation layer.

(34) The touch sensing layer TC may be disposed on the encapsulation layer ENC. The touch sensing layer TC may sense a user's contact or non-contact touch. For example, the touch sensing layer TC may sense a user's touch in a capacitive manner. For example, the touch sensing layer TC may sense a user's touch using a self-capacitance method or a mutual capacitance method.

Alternatively, the touch sensing layer TC may be omitted.

(35) The light collection layer CTL may be disposed on the touch sensing layer TC. For example, the light collection layer CTL may include a plurality of micro lenses. Accordingly, a light path of the first light L1 emitted from the first light emitting element **310** may be focused toward a third direction D3 intersecting the first direction D1 and the second direction D2. The third direction D3 may be perpendicular to the first direction D1 and the second direction D2. Alternatively, the light collection layer CTL may be omitted.

(36) The light guide layer **600** may be disposed on the encapsulation layer ENC. Specifically, the light guide layer **600** may be entirely cover the display area DA and the peripheral area PA.

(37) For example, as shown in FIG. 2B, when the display device **10** is in the second mode state, the second light L2 emitted from the second light emitting element **320** may be incident to a portion of the light guide layer **600** overlapping the peripheral area PA. The light guide layer **600** may transmit the second light L2 incident from the peripheral area PA to the display area DA.

(38) The second light L2 incident into the light guide layer **600** in the peripheral area PA may be transmitted to the display area DA by total reflection. In an embodiment, a refractive index of the light guide layer **600** may be greater than a refractive index of layers (e.g., the low refractive layer **500**) in contact with the upper and lower portions of the light guide layer **600**. Accordingly, the second light L2 incident into the light guide layer **600** in the peripheral area PA may be transmitted to the display area DA by total reflection.

(39) The light guide layer **600** may include an optical pattern **601**. In an embodiment, the optical pattern **601** may be formed on a lower surface of the light guide layer **600** overlapping the peripheral area PA. Specifically, the optical pattern **601** may have a structure protruding from the light guide layer **600** toward the encapsulation layer ENC. The optical pattern **601** may refract the second light L2 so that the second light L2 incident to the light guide layer **600** in the peripheral area PA is totally reflected into the light guide layer **600**. That is, as shown in FIG. 2B, the second light L2 emitted from the second light emitting element **320** may be refracted toward the display area DA (i.e., in the first direction D1) by the optical pattern **601**.

(40) The optical pattern **601** may be implemented as a diffraction optical element, a hologram optical element, a micro pattern, or the like.

(41) The low refractive layer **500** may be disposed on the encapsulation layer ENC. The low refractive layer **500** may be entirely disposed in the display area DA and the peripheral area PA. Specifically, the low refractive layer **500** may be disposed between the light guide layer **600** and the light control layer **400**. In an embodiment, the low refractive layer **500** may include a first low refractive layer **510** disposed under the light guide layer **600** and a second low refractive layer **520** disposed on the light guide layer **600**. That is, the first low refractive layer **510** and the second low refractive layer **520** may be spaced apart from each other in the third direction D3 with the light guide layer **600** disposed therebetween.

(42) In an embodiment, the first low refractive layer **510** may contact a lower surface of the light guide layer **600** and the second low refractive layer **520** may contact an upper surface of the light guide layer **600**.

(43) The first low refractive layer **510** may provide a substantially flat lower surface, and the second low refractive layer **520** may provide a substantially flat upper surface. Each of the first low refractive layer **510** and the second low refractive layer **520** may include an organic insulating material. In an embodiment, each of the first low refractive layer **510** and the second low refractive layer **520** may further include a plurality of air bubbles **511** and **521** disposed therein.

(44) A refractive index of each of the first low refractive layer **510** and the second low refractive layer **520** may be smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer **600**. In an embodiment, the refractive index of each of the first low refractive layer **510** and the second low refractive layer **520** may be smaller than the refractive index of the light guide layer **600** by about 0.2 or more. For example, the refractive index of each of the first low refractive layer **510** and the second low

refractive layer **520** may be about 1.2, and the refractive index of the light guide layer **600** may be about 1.5. Accordingly, the second light L2 incident into the light guide layer **600** in the peripheral area PA may be uniformly transmitted over the entire display area DA by total reflection at the interface between the light guide layer **600** and the low refractive layer **500** that includes the first low refractive layer **510** and the second low refractive layer **520**.

(45) The light control layer **400** may include a light blocking layer BM. The light blocking layer BM may be disposed in the display area DA on the encapsulation layer ENC. Specifically, the light blocking layer BM may be disposed in the light blocking area BA of the display area DA. The light blocking layer BM may be a black matrix. For example, the light blocking layer BM may include a light blocking material. The light blocking layer BM may prevent the visible light of different colors from being mixed or affecting each other. In an embodiment, the light blocking layer BM may be disposed under the first low refractive layer **510**.

(46) The light control layer **400** may be disposed in the display area DA on the encapsulation layer ENC. That is, the light control layer **400** may be disposed on the first light emitting element **310**. Specifically, the light control layer **400** may be disposed in an area corresponding to the light blocking area BA of the display area DA. The light control layer **400** may have openings OP1 and OP2 exposing the light emitting area LA. In addition, the light control layer **400** may be disposed to be spaced apart from the light guide layer **600** in the third direction D3.

(47) In an embodiment, the light control layer **400** may include a first light control layer **410** disposed under the first low refractive layer **510** and a second light control layer **420** disposed on the second low refractive layer **520**. That is, the first light control layer **410** and the second light control layer **420** may be spaced apart from each other in the third direction D3. In other words, the light control layer **400** may include two layers. Specifically, the first light control layer **410** may be the light blocking layer BM described herein above.

(48) The first light control layer **410** may have a first opening OP1 exposing the light emitting area LA and the second light control layer **420** may have a second opening OP2 exposing the light emitting area LA. The first opening OP1 and the second opening OP2 may overlap with each other. In addition, the first light emitting element **310** may overlap the first opening OP1 and the second opening OP2, respectively. That is, each of the first opening OP1 and the second opening OP2 may overlap the light emitting area LA. For example, each of the first light control layer **410** and the second light control layer **420** may not overlap the light emitting area LA.

(49) Each of the first light control layer **410** and the second light control layer **420** may include a photochromic material that changes colors when exposed to light having a specific wavelength range. For example, the photochromic material may include spiropyran, diarylethene, azobenzene, or the like. These may be used alone or in combination with each other. However, it is illustrative, and the present inventive concept is not limited thereto.

(50) The photochromic material may be discolored by the second light L2 (e.g., ultraviolet light) having the second wavelength range. The photochromic material may not be discolored by the first light L1 (e.g., visible light) having the first wavelength range. In addition, the photochromic material may transmit the first light L1 in a state in which the photochromic material is not discolored by the second light L2. The photochromic material may absorb the first light L1 and block the first light L1 when it is discolored by the second light L2. For example, the photochromic material may have a transmittance of about 30% or less with respect to the first light L1 when it is discolored by the second light L2.

(51) The plurality of scattering patterns **700** may be disposed on the light guide layer **600**. Specifically, the scattering patterns **700** may be disposed between the light guide layer **600** and the second low refractive layer **520**. In an embodiment, each of the scattering patterns **700** may contact the upper surface of the light guide layer **600**. The second low refractive layer **520** may cover the scattering patterns **700**. In addition, each of the scattering patterns **700** may overlap the first light control layer **410** and the second light control layer **420**. That is, the scattering patterns **700** may be

disposed to be spaced apart from each other at a predetermined interval along the first direction D1. For example, an upper surface of each of the scattering patterns **700** may have a convex shape in a cross-sectional view.

(52) As shown in FIG. 2B, at least a portion of the second light L2 transmitted in the first direction D1 from the inside of the light guide layer **600** may proceed to the scattering patterns **700** disposed in the display area DA. A portion of the second light L2 traveled to the scattering patterns **700** may be scattered by the scattering patterns **700**. Accordingly, a portion of the second light L2 may be emitted to outside of the light guide layer **600** (e.g., the light control layer **400**) without being totally reflected into the light guide layer **600**. Another portion of the second light L2 that is not emitted to the outside of the light guide layer **600** may be transmitted in the first direction D1 by total reflection at the interface between the light guide layer **600** and the low refractive layer **500** into the light guide layer **600**.

(53) Each of the scattering patterns **700** may include a plurality of scattering particles **710** dispersed in an insulating film **720**. For example, each of the scattering particles **710** may include titanium oxide (TiO.sub.x). For example, the insulating film **720** may include an organic insulating material.

(54) In an embodiment, a width of each of the scattering patterns **700** in the first direction D1 and the second direction D2 may be smaller than a width of each of the first light control layer **410** and the second light control layer **420** in the first direction D1 and the second direction D2.

Accordingly, an emission of a portion of the second light L2 scattered by the scattering patterns **700** to the outside of the display device **10** through the openings OP1 and OP2 of the light control layer **400** may be reduced.

(55) FIGS. 3A and 3B are plan views illustrating an example of a light control layer of FIG. 2A. For example, FIG. 3B may be an enlarged view of a partial area of the light control layer **400a** illustrated in FIG. 3A.

(56) Referring to FIGS. 1, 2A, 2B, 3A, and 3B, in an embodiment, the light control layer **400a** may have a slit shape in the plan view. For example, the light control layer **400a** may include a plurality of stripe patterns that extend in the second direction D2 and are arranged along the first direction D1. That is, the openings OP formed in the light control layer **400a** may extend in the second direction D2 and may be arranged along the first direction D1.

(57) Each of the openings OP may overlap the plurality of light emitting areas LA arranged in the second direction D2. In the second mode state, the viewing angle of the display device **10** in the first direction D1 may be reduced, but the viewing angle of the display device **10** in the second direction D2 may not be reduced. To reduce the viewing angle of the display device **10** in the second direction D2, the light control layer **400a** may include a plurality of stripe patterns that extends in the first direction D1 and arranged along the second direction D2.

(58) FIGS. 4A and 4B are plan views illustrating another example of a light control layer of FIG. 2A. For example, FIG. 4B may be an enlarged view of a partial area of the light control layer **400b** illustrated in FIG. 4A.

(59) Referring to FIGS. 1, 2A, 2B, 4A, and 4B, in an embodiment, the light control layer **400b** may have a lattice shape in the plan view. In other words, the openings OP formed in the light control layer **400b** may be arranged in a matrix shape along the first direction D1 and the second direction D2. Each of the openings OP may overlap each of the light emitting areas LA. For example, in a plan view, an area of each of the openings OP may be the same as an area of each of the light emitting areas LA. In the second mode state, both the viewing angle in the first direction D1 and the viewing angle in the second direction D2 of the display device **10** may be reduced.

(60) Referring back to FIGS. 2A and 2B, the light absorption layer **800** may be disposed on the second light control layer **420**. Specifically, the light absorption layer **800** may entirely cover the display area DA and the peripheral area PA. The light absorption layer **800** may selectively absorb the second light L2 having the second wavelength range. That is, the light absorption layer **800** may block the second light L2 from being emitted to the outside of the display device **10**. In

addition, the light absorption layer **800** may block light incident from the outside of the display device **10** having the second wavelength range (e.g., ultraviolet light). The light absorption layer **800** may transmit the first light L1 having the first wavelength range (e.g., visible light).

(61) The second substrate **900** may include a transparent material. For example, the second substrate **900** may include glass, quartz, plastic, or the like. The second substrate **900** may transmit the first light L1 emitted from the first light emitting element **310**.

(62) Hereinafter, an operation of the display device **10** in the first mode state and the second mode state will be described with reference to FIGS. 2A and 2B.

(63) When the display device **10** is in the first mode state illustrated in FIG. 2A, the first driving element **210** may drive the first light emitting element **310** and the second driving element **220** may not drive the second light emitting element **320**. In this case, the first light L1 (e.g., visible light) may be emitted from the first light emitting element **310** and the light may not be emitted from the second light emitting element **320**. Accordingly, the light control layer **400** may not be discolored. Accordingly, the light control layer **400** may transmit the first light L1. That is, the first light L1 emitted from the light emitting area LA may not be blocked by the light control layer **400**, but may be emitted to the outside of the display device **10** through the second substrate **900**. Accordingly, the display device **10** may have the wide viewing angle in the first mode state.

(64) When the display device **10** is switched to the second mode state illustrated in FIG. 2B, the second driving element **220** may drive the second light emitting element **320**. Accordingly, the second light L2 (e.g., ultraviolet light) may be emitted from the second light emitting element **320**. As described above, the second light L2 emitted from the second light emitting element **320** may be transmitted to the display area DA through the light guide layer **600**. In addition, a portion of the second light L2 transmitted from the light guide layer **600** may be emitted to the outside (e.g., the light control layer **400**) of the light guide layer **600** by the scattering patterns **700**. Accordingly, the light control layer **400**, for example, the second light control layer **420**, may be discolored. Accordingly, the first light L1 traveling toward the light control layer **400** among the first lights L1 emitted from the light emitting area LA may be blocked by the light control layer **400**.

(65) Among the first lights L1 emitted from the light emitting area LA, the first light L1 traveling toward the openings OP1 and OP2 may be not blocked by the light control layer **400** and may be emitted to the outside of the display device **10** through the second substrate **900**. That is, when the display device **10** is in the second mode state, the light control layer **400** may block the first light L1 having an incident angle greater than or equal to a predetermined angle among the first lights L1 emitted from the light emitting area LA. Accordingly, the display device **10** may have the narrow viewing angle in the second mode state.

(66) When the display device **10** is switched back to the first mode state, the second driving element **220** may not drive the second light emitting element **320**. In this case, no light is emitted from the second light emitting element **320** and the color of the light control layer **400** may be restored to original state of the light control layer **400**. Accordingly, the light control layer **400** may again transmit the first light L1 and the display device **10** may again have the wide viewing angle.

(67) When the light control layer **400** including a photochromic material that is discolored by light having a specific wavelength range is disposed adjacent to or in direct contact with the light guide layer **600** that transmits the light incident on the peripheral area PA to the display area DA, the total reflection of the light incident on the peripheral area PA may not be occurred, and thus the light may not be uniformly transmitted to the entire display area DA.

(68) In the display device **10** according to an embodiment of the present inventive concept, the first low refractive layer **510** having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer **600** may be disposed under the light guide layer **600**. The second low refractive layer **520** having a refractive index smaller than the refractive index of the light guide layer **600** may be disposed on the light guide layer **600**. In addition, the first light control layer **410** including a photochromic material that is discolored by the second light L2 (e.g., ultraviolet light) may be

disposed under the first low refractive layer **510**. The second light control layer **420** including a photochromic material that is discolored by the second light L2 may be disposed on the second low refractive layer **520**. In this case, a loss of the second light L2 that discolours the photochromic material may be reduced. Accordingly, the second light L2 incident into the light guide layer **600** from the peripheral area PA may be uniformly transmitted over the entire display area DA by total reflection at an interface between the light guide layer **600** and the low refractive layer **500**.

(69) FIG. 5 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a display device according to another embodiment.

(70) Referring to FIG. 5, the display device **11** according to another embodiment of the present inventive concept includes the first substrate **100**, the insulating structure IL, the first driving element **210**, the first light emitting element **310**, the second driving element **220**, the second light emitting element **320**, the pixel defining layer PDL, the encapsulation layer ENC, the touch sensing layer TC, the light collection layer CTL, the light control layer **400**, the low refractive layer **500**, the light guide layer **600**, the scattering patterns **700**, the light absorption layer **800**, and the second substrate **900**. The display device **11** described with reference to FIG. 5 may be substantially the same as or similar to the display device **10** described with reference to FIGS. 1, 2A, and 2B except for a position of the scattering patterns **700**. Hereinafter, overlapping descriptions will be omitted.

(71) The scattering patterns **700** may be disposed on the encapsulation layer ENC. Specifically, the scattering patterns **700** may be disposed on the first low refractive layer **510**. In addition, each of the scattering patterns **700** may overlap the light control layer **400**.

(72) In an embodiment, each of the scattering patterns **700** may contact an upper surface of the first low refractive layer **510** and a lower surface of the light guide layer **600**, respectively. That is, the light guide layer **600** may cover the scattering patterns **700**.

(73) According to another embodiment of the present inventive concept, the display device **11** may display an image in a first mode state implemented with the wide viewing angle or the second mode state implemented with the narrow viewing angle. Accordingly, the viewing angle of the display device **11** may be adjusted.

(74) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a display device according to still another embodiment.

(75) Referring to FIG. 6, the display device **12** according to still another embodiment may include the first substrate **100**, the insulating structure IL, the first driving element **210**, the first light emitting element **310**, the second driving element **220**, the second light emitting element **320**, the pixel defining layer PDL, the encapsulation layer ENC, the touch sensing layer TC, the light collection layer CTL, the light control layer **400**, the low refractive layer **500**, the light guide layer **600**, the scattering patterns **700**, an insulating layer **750**, the light absorption layer **800**, and the second substrate **900**. The display device **12** described with reference to FIG. 6 may be substantially the same as or similar to the display device **10** described with reference to FIGS. 1, 2A, and 2B except that the display device **12** further includes a third light control layer **430** and the insulating layer **750**. Hereinafter, overlapping descriptions will be omitted.

(76) The light control layer **400** may be disposed in the display area DA on the encapsulation layer ENC. The light control layer **400** may have openings OP1, OP2, and OP3 exposing the light emitting area LA. In addition, the light control layer **400** may be spaced apart from the light guide layer **600** in the third direction D3.

(77) As described above, the light control layer **400** may include the first light control layer **410** disposed under the first low refractive layer **510** and the second light control layer **420** disposed on the second low refractive layer **520**. The first light control layer **410** may have the first opening OP1 exposing the light emitting area LA and the second light control layer **420** may have the second opening OP2 exposing the light emitting area LA.

(78) In an embodiment, the light control layer **400** may further include a third light control layer **430** disposed on the second light control layer **420** with the insulating layer **750** disposed therebetween. The third light control layer **430** may have a third opening OP3 exposing the light

emitting area LA.

(79) The first to third openings OP1, OP2, and OP3 may overlap each other. In addition, each of the first to third openings OP1, OP2, and OP3 may overlap the light emitting area LA. For example, each of the first to third light control layers **410**, **420**, and **430** may not overlap the light emitting area LA.

(80) Each of the first to third light control layers **410**, **420**, and **430** may include a photochromic material that is discolored by light having a specific wavelength range, for example, the second light L2 (e.g., ultraviolet light). For example, the photochromic material may include spiropyran, diarylethene, azobenzene, or the like. These may be used alone or in combination with each other.

(81) The insulating layer **750** may be disposed on the second low refractive layer **520** on the second light control layer **420**. The insulating layer **750** may entirely cover the display area DA and the peripheral area PA. Specifically, the insulating layer **750** may be disposed between the second light control layer **420** and the third light control layer **430**. In addition, the insulating layer **750** may cover the second light control layer **420**. For example, the insulating layer **750** may include an organic insulating material.

(82) The light absorption layer **800** may be disposed on the insulating layer **750**. The light absorption layer **800** may cover the third light control layer **430**. The light absorption layer **800** may selectively absorb the second light L2 having the second wavelength range.

(83) According to still another embodiment of the present inventive concept, the display device **12** may display an image in the first mode state implemented with the wide viewing angle or the second mode state implemented with the narrow viewing angle. Accordingly, the viewing angle of the display device **12** may be adjusted.

(84) FIGS. 7A and 7B are a cross-sectional view illustrating a display device according to still another embodiment. For example, FIG. 7A may illustrate the display device **13** in a first mode state and FIG. 7B may illustrate the display device **13** in a second mode state. The first mode state may be a mode for implementing a wide viewing angle and the second mode state may mean a mode for implementing a narrow viewing angle mode.

(85) Referring to FIGS. 7A and 7B, the display device **13** according to still another embodiment of the present inventive concept may include the first substrate **100**, the insulating structure IL, the first driving element **210**, the first light emitting element **310**, a second light emitting element **1000**, the pixel defining layer PDL, the encapsulation layer ENC, the touch sensing layer TC, the light collection layer CTL, the light control layer **400**, the low refractive layer **500**, the light guide layer **600**, the scattering patterns **700**, the light absorption layer **800**, and the second substrate **900**. The display device **13** described with reference to FIGS. 7A and 7B may be substantially the same or similar to the display device **10** described with reference to FIGS. 1, 2A and 2B except for a position of the second light emitting element **1000**.

(86) The first light emitting element **310** may be disposed in the display area DA on the first substrate **100**. Specifically, the first light emitting element **310** may be disposed in the light emitting area LA on the first substrate **100**. The first light emitting element **310** may emit the first light L1 having a first wavelength range. The first light L1 may be visible light.

(87) In an embodiment, the second light emitting element **1000** may be disposed outside a display panel. Specifically, the second light emitting element **1000** may be disposed on at least one side of the display device **13**. For example, the second light emitting element **1000** may be disposed on the side of the display device **13** to face the light guide layer **600**. The light emitting surface **1001** of the second light emitting element **1000** may face one side **602** of the light guide layer **600**. For example, the second light emitting element **1000** and the display panel may be fixed by a housing (not shown).

(88) The second light emitting element **1000** may emit the second light L2 having a second wavelength range different from the first wavelength range. For example, the second light L2 may be ultraviolet or infrared light.

(89) The second light emitting element **1000** may selectively emit the second light L2. That is, in the first mode state, the second light L2 may not be emitted from the second light emitting element **1000**. In the second mode state, the second light L2 may be emitted from the second light emitting element **1000**. In the second mode state, the second light L2 may be emitted from the light emitting surface **1001** of the second light emitting element **1000** in the first direction D1, and may be incident into the light guide layer **600** through the one side **602** of the light guide layer **600**. The second light L2 incident into the light guide layer **600** may be transmitted to the display area DA by total reflection.

(90) In the present embodiment, an optical pattern (e.g., the optical pattern **601** of FIG. 2A) may not be formed on the lower surface of the light guide layer **600** overlapping the peripheral area PA.

(91) Hereinafter, an operation of the display device **13** in the first mode state and the second mode state will be described with reference to FIGS. 7A and 7B.

(92) When the display device **13** is in the first mode state shown in FIG. 7A, the first light L1 (e.g., visible light) may be emitted from the first light emitting element **310** and light may not be emitted from the second light emitting element **1000**. Accordingly, the light control layer **400** may not be discolored. Accordingly, the light control layer **400** may transmit the first light L1. That is, the first light L1 emitted from the light emitting area LA may not be blocked by the light control layer **400**, but may be emitted to the outside of the display device **13** through the second substrate **900**.

Accordingly, the display device **13** may have the wide viewing angle in the first mode state.

(93) When the display device **13** is in the second mode state illustrated in FIG. 7B, the second light L2 (e.g., ultraviolet light) may be emitted from the second light emitting element **1000**. As described above, the second light L2 emitted from the second light emitting element **1000** may be transmitted to the display area DA through the light guide layer **600**. In addition, a portion of the second light L2 transmitted to the light guide layer **600** may be emitted to the outside (e.g., the light control layer **400**) of the light guide layer **600** by the scattering patterns **700**. Accordingly, the light control layer **400** may be discolored. Accordingly, the first light L1 traveling toward the light control layer **400** among the first lights L1 emitted from the light emitting area LA may be blocked by the light control layer **400**.

(94) Among the first lights L1 emitted from the light emitting area LA, the first light L1 traveling toward the openings OP1 and OP2 may be not blocked by the light control layer **400** and may be emitted to the outside of the display device **13** through the second substrate **900**. That is, when the display device **13** is in the second mode state, the light control layer **400** may block the first light L1 having an incident angle greater than or equal to a predetermined angle among the first lights L1 emitted from the light emitting area LA. Accordingly, the display device **13** may have the narrow viewing angle in the second mode state.

(95) When the display device **13** is switched back to the first mode state, the second light L2 may not be emitted from the second light emitting element **1000** and the color of the light control layer **400** may be restored to original state of the light control layer **400**. Accordingly, the light control layer **400** may again transmit the first light L1 and the display device **13** may again have the wide viewing angle.

(96) The present disclosure can be applied to various display devices that may include a display device. For example, the present disclosure can be applied to high-resolution smartphones, mobile phones, smart pads, smart watches, tablet PCs, in-vehicle navigation systems, televisions, computer monitors, notebook computers, and the like.

(97) The foregoing is illustrative of embodiments and is not to be construed as limiting thereof. Although a few embodiments have been described, those skilled in the art will readily appreciate that many modifications are possible in the embodiments without materially departing from the novel teachings and advantages of the present inventive concept. Accordingly, all such modifications are intended to be included within the scope of the present inventive concept as defined in the claims. Therefore, it is to be understood that the foregoing is illustrative of various

embodiments and is not to be construed as limited to the specific embodiments disclosed, and that modifications to the disclosed embodiments, as well as other embodiments, are intended to be included within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A display device comprising: a substrate including a display area including a light emitting area and a light blocking area, and a peripheral area surrounding at least a portion of the display area; a first light emitting element disposed in the light emitting area on the substrate and emitting a first light; a light guide layer disposed on the first light emitting element to cover the display area and the peripheral area, and transmitting a second light incident from the peripheral area to the display area; a first low refractive layer disposed on the light guide layer and having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer; a second low refractive layer disposed under the light guide layer and having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer; and a first light control layer disposed on the first low refractive layer and having a first opening exposing the light emitting area, wherein the first light control layer includes a photochromic material that is discolored by the second light.
2. The display device of claim 1, further comprising: a second light control layer disposed under the second low refractive layer and having a second opening exposing the light emitting area.
3. The display device of claim 2, wherein the second light control layer includes a photochromic material that is discolored by the second light.
4. The display device of claim 2, wherein the first light control layer directly contacts the first low refractive layer and the second light control layer directly contacts the second low refractive layer.
5. The display device of claim 2, wherein the first opening and the second opening overlaps with each other and the first light emitting element overlaps the first opening and the second opening, respectively.
6. The display device of claim 2, further comprising: a third light control layer disposed on the first light control layer, having a third opening exposing the light emitting area, and including a photochromic material that is discolored by the second light.
7. The display device of claim 6, further comprising: an insulating layer disposed between the first light control layer and the third light control layer, and covering the first light control layer.
8. The display device of claim 1, further comprising: a plurality of scattering patterns disposed between the light guide layer and an upper surface of the first low refractive layer, each of the scattering patterns overlapping the first light control layer.
9. The display device of claim 8, wherein each of the scattering patterns includes an insulating film and a plurality of scattering particles dispersed in the insulating film.
10. The display device of claim 8, wherein a width of each of the scattering patterns is smaller than a width of the first light control layer.
11. The display device of claim 1, wherein each of the first low refractive layer and the second low refractive layer includes a plurality of air bubbles disposed therein.
12. The display device of claim 1, wherein a refractive index of each of the first low refractive layer and the second low refractive layer is smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer by about 0.2 or more.
13. The display device of claim 1, further comprising: a second light emitting element disposed in the peripheral area on the substrate and emitting the second light.
14. The display device of claim 1, further comprising: a second light emitting element disposed to face a side surface of the light guide layer and emitting the second light.
15. The display device of claim 1, wherein the first light is visible light and the second light is infrared or ultraviolet light.
16. A display device comprising: a substrate including a display area including a light emitting area

and a light blocking area, and a peripheral area surrounding at least a portion of the display area; a first light emitting element disposed in the light emitting area on the substrate and emitting a first light; a light guide layer disposed on the first light emitting element to cover the display area and the peripheral area, and transmitting a second light incident from the peripheral area to the display area; a light control layer disposed in the display area on the first light emitting element, having an opening exposing the light emitting area, and disposed to be spaced apart from the light guide layer; and a low refractive layer disposed between the light guide layer and the light control layer, and having a refractive index smaller than a refractive index of the light guide layer, wherein the light control layer includes a photochromic material that is discolored by the second light.

17. The display device of claim 16, wherein the low refractive layer includes: a first low refractive layer disposed on the light guide layer; and a second low refractive layer disposed under the light guide layer.

18. The display device of claim 17, wherein each of the first low refractive layer and the second low refractive layer includes a plurality of air bubbles disposed therein.

19. The display device of claim 17, wherein the light control layer includes: a first light control layer disposed on the first low refractive layer; and a second light control layer disposed under the second low refractive layer.

20. The display device of claim 19, further comprising: a plurality of scattering patterns disposed between the light guide layer and an upper surface of the first low refractive layer, each of the scattering patterns overlapping the first light control layer.
